Airway Management – Section Summary

RSI • Difficult airway • Complications • Tracheostomy • Angioedema

Critical Care Board Review • Section 14 • MCQ-Oriented

1. Intubation

- Botulism/myasthenia → **fentanyl, etomidate, rocuronium** (avoid sux)
- Unstable C-spine/facial trauma → **awake fibreoptic** (or surgical)
- Failed intubation, can ventilate → **supraglottic airway**
- Angioedema with airway threat → **awake intubation**; anaphylactic → **epinephrine**
- Negative-pressure pulmonary oedema follows **Mueller manoeuvre**

2. Complications

- Post-thyroid/neck surgery dyspnoea → **compressive haematoma**
- Malignant hyperthermia → **stop volatiles**, dantrolene
- Hyperventilation on capnography: ↓ $ETCO_2$ amplitude/width

3. Tracheostomy

- Early (< 7 d) complications: bleeding, dislodgement — **TEF is late**
- Decannulation criteria institution-dependent
- Trach-innominate fistula → **oral ETT + digital compression**

4. High-Yield MCQ Pearls

- ☑ Avoid sux in neuromuscular disease
- ☑ Neck haematoma → open the wound

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